

Activity: Build the Kill Chain – Trace the Path of a Breach

Stage	What Happened	Detection Opportunity	Helpful Control
1. Reconnaissance	Attacker waiting for someone to click link	malware/anti-virus scanner might have placed email in junk	malware/anti-virus scanning software
2. Delivery	Phishing email sent to employee	Email filter or phishing training	Secure email gateway, awareness training
3. Exploitation	Attacker uploads folder with PII to an external server	Log monitoring sys. with alerts	Encryption of client PII/ network segmentation
4. Installation	Attacker creates suspicious scheduled task	IDS–intrusion detection system possibly	Role based access, or least privilege/ network segmentation
5. Command and control	Attacker is in the system, and has set up a task, might also have gotten admin privileges-bad	If MFA installed, perhaps it could have limited scope	IDS/MFA, network segmentation, other mitigation techniques
6. Actions on Objectives	Customer data has been compromised, system altered, mitigation needs to happen here	Having alerts to suspicious activity sent to security team, if not already in place	Discovery, mitigation, and remediation

-If I were on the security team, I would say that we could have all the technical tools in the world available, but we cannot control what a person will click on, so I would focus more on employee training to combat Phishing, and other social engineering attacks. Clicking on the link is what started this whole process, and without that, the attacker(s) would probably not have had access to the system.